Project B - Warehouse Operations Manual

Introduction

This manual describes the standard procedures for warehouse staff using the Project B inventory system at the Leeds, Bristol and Glasgow warehouses. It is intended for operatives and supervisors. Procedures use the handheld scanner application; supervisors also use the web interface.

If the handheld loses its network connection, continue scanning. Scans are queued for up to 30 minutes and uploaded in order when the connection returns. Do not scan the same item twice to check whether the scan worked.

Procedure 1: Goods-in receiving

Purpose: Ensure every delivery is checked, recorded and available for put-away.

1. Match the delivery note to the purchase order at the dock door.

2. Scan the pallet label to create a goods-in movement.

3. Inspect packaging for damage and photograph any damage before signing the driver's paperwork.

4. Place the pallet in the receiving bay and tag it with a put-away task.

Note: Receiving must be recorded within 15 minutes of the pallet leaving the vehicle.

Procedure 2: Put-away

Purpose: Move received stock to its storage location and record it.

1. Take the next put-away task on the handheld.

2. Scan the pallet, then scan the destination bay label.

3. If the bay label does not match the task, do not override; call a supervisor.

4. Confirm the quantity if the pallet was split.

Note: Fast-moving items are stored in bays 1 to 20 closest to the dispatch area.

Procedure 3: Picking

Purpose: Collect items for customer orders accurately and efficiently.

1. Select a pick wave on the handheld.

2. Scan each bay label, then scan the item barcode.

3. Enter the quantity; the system rejects quantities above the stock level.

4. Place picked items in the tote and scan the tote label when finished.

Note: The target pick accuracy is 99.7 percent, measured weekly.

Procedure 4: Cycle counting

Purpose: Verify stock records by counting a small number of locations each day.

1. Open the daily count list; the system selects 40 locations per warehouse using a risk-based rule.

2. Count blind: the expected quantity is hidden.

3. Enter the counted quantity.

4. Differences above 2 percent trigger a recount by a second operative.

Note: Adjustments above 50 units require supervisor approval.

Procedure 5: Damaged goods

Purpose: Handle damaged stock safely and keep the records correct.

1. Move the item to the quarantine cage in bay 90.

2. Scan it with the reason code DMG.

3. Photograph the damage and attach the photo to the record.

4. The supervisor decides between return to supplier, repair or write-off.

Note: Items must not stay in quarantine longer than 14 days.

Procedure 6: Cold-chain handling

Purpose: Protect temperature-controlled goods from spoilage.

1. Cold-chain pallets are flagged on the goods-in screen with a blue banner.

2. Cold-chain pallets must be moved to Bay 31 within 12 minutes of receipt.

3. Check the logger reading at the door and record it; readings above 8 degrees Celsius mean the pallet must be rejected.

4. Never stack cold-chain pallets more than two high.

Note: Bay 31 is monitored; a temperature alarm sends an alert to the shift supervisor.

Procedure 7: Transfers between warehouses

Purpose: Move stock between Leeds, Bristol and Glasgow while keeping both inventories correct.

1. Create a transfer order from the supervisor screen.

2. The sending warehouse picks and scans items to the transfer bay; this creates a transfer-out movement.

3. The goods travel on the internal trunk service, which runs daily at 14:00.

4. The receiving warehouse scans each pallet; this creates a transfer-in movement.

Note: Stock in transit is shown as a separate quantity and is not available for picking.

Procedure 8: Shift handover

Purpose: Make sure the next shift knows the state of the warehouse.

1. Print the shift summary report from the supervisor screen.

2. List open put-away tasks, damaged items in quarantine and any equipment faults.

3. Walk the next supervisor through the list and both sign on the handheld.

4. Return handheld devices to the charging dock and report any that are damaged.

Note: The handover takes place 15 minutes before the shift ends.

Summary of time limits

Procedure	Limit
Goods-in recording	15 minutes from unloading
Cold-chain move to Bay 31	12 minutes from receipt
Quarantine stay	14 days
Shift handover	15 minutes before shift end
Offline queue	30 minutes